

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 240

By Powers

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the celebration of St. Patrick's Day.

WHEREAS, on March 17, the annual celebration of the Feast of Saint Patrick, Irish Americans join with men, women, and children of all other ethnic origins who, for one day, become Irish and celebrate both St. Patrick and their love of Ireland; and

WHEREAS, on St. Patrick's Day, all who wear the green live for a day in the spirit of the three Patron Saints of Ireland, Saint Patrick, Saint Brigid, and Saint Colmcille; and

WHEREAS, Irish immigrants to Tennessee helped form the cultural foundation of this State, and those Tennesseans of Irish lineage continue to proudly sing support for Ireland today; and

WHEREAS, the songs of Ireland are the tragic songs of love and the joyous songs of battle; they are the nostalgic reveries of the sorrows and glories that are the Emerald Isle, the lamentations of life's myriad travails, and the odes to joy and the life eternal; and

WHEREAS, today, nearly one in ten Americans identify as being of Irish ancestry; Irish immigrants helped build the America we know today, not only the physical infrastructure, but also the political construct that is America; and

WHEREAS, the American War of Independence began in April 1775 at Lexington and Concord, where "the shot heard 'round the world" continues to echo to this day; that action 250 years ago inspired Ireland and others in many nations to continue to struggle to be free and to choose their own destiny; and

WHEREAS, the American-Irish relationship is a shining example of how ancestral ties, historical connections, cultural affinities, and shared values can create a foundation for enduring partnership and mutual prosperity; and

WHEREAS, Irish-American state legislators across the United States are playing a vitally important role in fostering this partnership and ensuring that it continues and flourishes for another century to come; and

WHEREAS, we are pleased to honor the American Irish State Legislators Caucus and its aim of fostering and strengthening the longstanding relationship that exists between the United States of America and the Republic of Ireland and mutually benefits both countries; and

WHEREAS, all Tennesseans are Irish on St. Patrick's Day, and as we wear the green and sing Irish songs on this day of celebration, we most confidently state, "Erin go Bragh"; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commemorate the celebration of St. Patrick's Day on March 17, the annual celebration of the Feast of Saint Patrick, the Patron Saint of Ireland.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.